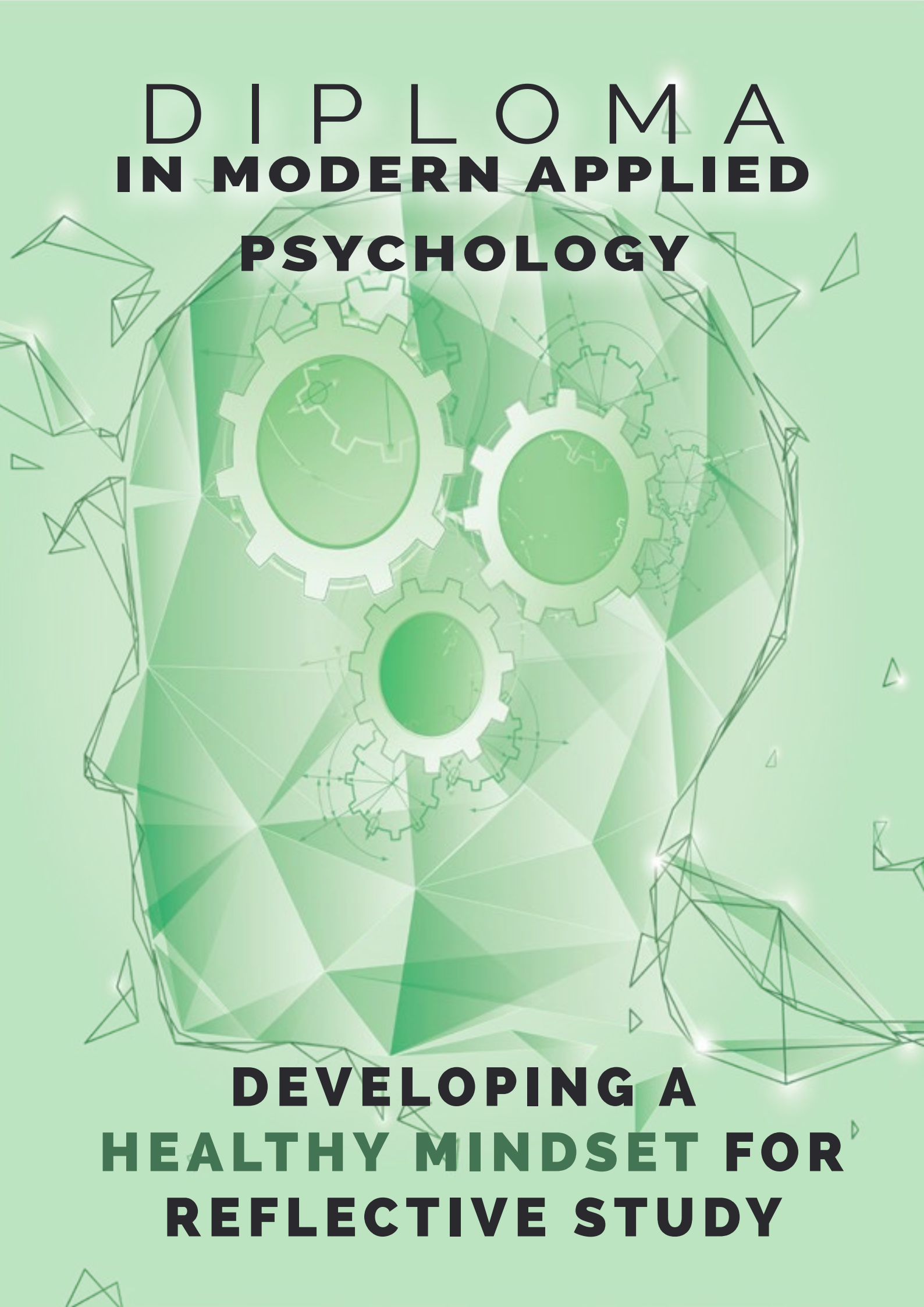


The background is a vibrant green with a complex, abstract geometric pattern. It features a large, central, faceted shape resembling a crystal or a stylized head, composed of various shades of green triangles and polygons. Overlaid on this are three interlocking gears of different sizes, rendered in a lighter green with white outlines. Thin, white lines and arrows suggest movement and connectivity throughout the design.

DIPLOMA IN MODERN APPLIED PSYCHOLOGY

DEVELOPING A HEALTHY MINDSET FOR REFLECTIVE STUDY

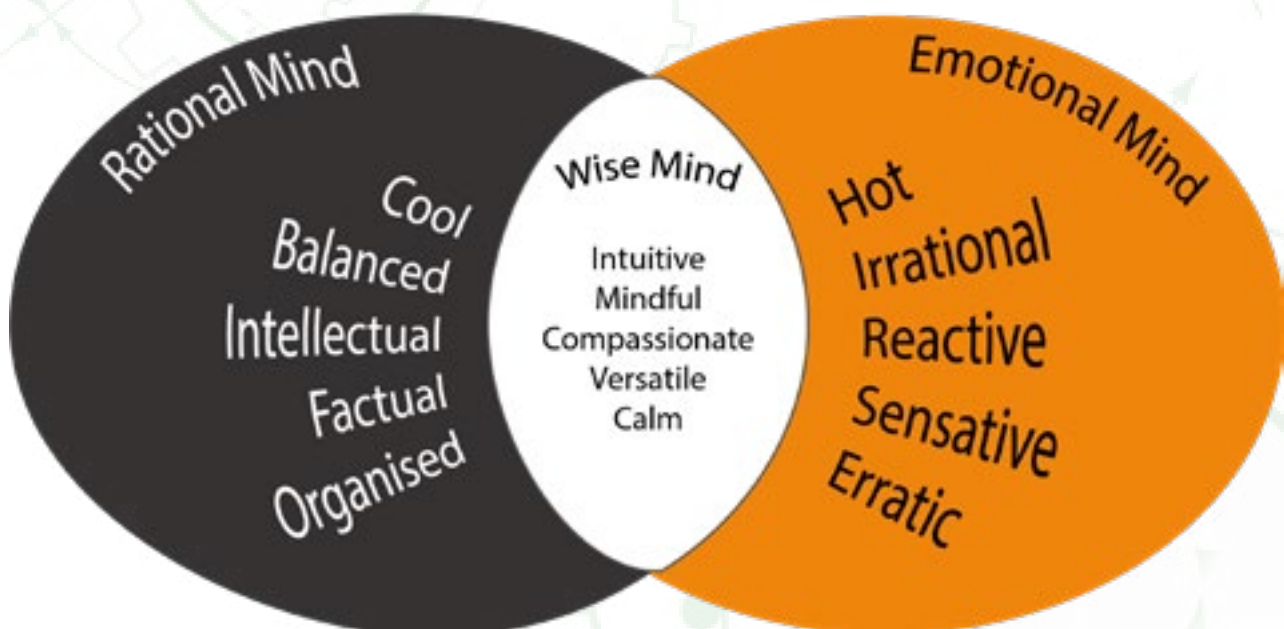
DEVELOPING A HEALTHY MINDSET

Farmers understand their limitations in life; they know what they can take responsibility for and what they cannot. They know they can take responsibility for planting the seeds for their crops, protecting the seeds with netting or scarecrows, fertilising the soil and watering the seeds, but they know that that's the extent of their powers. They cannot force their seeds to grow, nor can they prevent certain seeds from dying. There are certain aspects of nature which are totally out of their grasp, but they do everything within their power to maximise their harvest to the best of their abilities.

This principles of the harvest are applicable to psychology or, more precisely, communication. You can be incredibly well versed in human psychology and philosophy, you may know all the tactics and poignant angles to take, but unless you communicate in a way which translates well with people, your efforts will be in vain.

Before we start helping others, we need to understand our minds and how we process information and our life experiences. Having a healthy mindset so its conducive to reflective study which is why understanding the wise mind model is so important.

The human mind can be our greatest ally or our most troublesome enemy if we don't fully understand it or how we can manage it. The wise mind model is a basic model which helps us understand ourselves by looking at the mind not from a scientific perspective, but from a more practical perspective. The human mind has three states: The Reasonable Mind, the Emotional Mind, and the Wise Mind. We all possess each of these states, but the majority of people operate in a specific one most of the time.



DEVELOPING A **HEALTHY MINDSET**

THE EMOTIONAL MIND: Have you ever had a conversation with someone which revolves entirely around how they feel, what they think, what they believe, etc. They're quite tiresome conversations. Everyone has an emotional mind of some level because we're all born into it; we're born unable to articulate, analyse and philosophise our conditions. So we scream, we cry and throw tantrums. The emotional mind can sometimes be irrational, reactive and disconnected from other people. The emotional part of our mind triggers and gives voice to the emotions we're feeling, whether we're feeling doubtful, fearful or happy. People who act predominantly out of the emotional part of their mind are usually very easy to read and tend to be more reactive in situations they find themselves in, investing less time into mental processing than those who operate out of the thinking mind. This is because emotional people respond to emotions as though they were facts rather than subjective experiences.

If the rational mind is something like a controlled, enclosed, scientific laboratory, the emotional mind is more like the ocean where any weather can occur. The emotional mind is the place of feelings where emotions determine an individual's thoughts and behaviours. People who are emotionally driven can be a little unreliable and may act impulsively and give little consideration to the consequences because the quality of their life is emotionally dependable, meaning their lives lack a stable foundation and such instability goes onto impact others directly or indirectly. The emotional mind doesn't necessarily work with facts, but it generally works on what it believes the truth is, or a perception of truth, or merely a projection of what it thinks the truth might be. They usually state they disagree with something because they "feel x" or "believe y" rather than referring to empirical data.

THE RATIONAL MIND: Think about a past conversation you've had with someone who has cut off your emotional dialogue in order to bombard it with rational thought. By dismissing your emotional validity by labelling them as irrelevant and irrational, these people can come across as heartless and insensitive. People who are highly academic or grounded in logic tend to engage in power-dynamic orientated dialectic. They're usually opinionated thinkers who focus more on what's right and what's wrong and cushion their arguments and opinions with facts and information. The rational mind relies on information and facts, it is cold, calculating and plans without taking into consideration other human qualities, often to the detriment of productivity or effectiveness. Whilst all this is admirable and worthy, facts, opinions and information, these things are all worthless unless they're incorporated into a person's life and acted upon. Many people fall into the trap of overintellectualising what they're experiencing emotionally.

An individual uses the rational part of their mind when approaching a situation intellectually, but this often leads to a battle of wits rather than seeking understanding. The rational mind can be 'unfeeling', even cruel. It is often uncompromising and follows rules. There's one thing being knowledgeable, but it's something else to be understanding and open-minded.

THE WISE MIND: The wise part of our mind is developed through our ability to think critically i.e. not falling victim to responding wholly emotionally or over-rationally to certain ideas and situations. The wise mind is the balance between the rational and the emotional mind. It exists when an individual recognises and respects their feelings, but is still able to respond to them rationally and maturely. The wise mind is where the rational mind and the emotional mind overlap; it's the part of every person that can know and experience truth; where order and chaos can mingle in a meaningful way and where one can experience a feeling and understand the reasoning behind it.



DEVELOPING A HEALTHY MINDSET

The goal of the wise mind is not to become a greater thinker in terms of philosophy or academia, but to become more reflective. The wise mind communicates ideas and responses in a simple and accessible way which isn't blinded by emotion or complex intellectualism. Honest reflection allows us to formulate more simple, philosophical ideas which we can communicate to other people without allowing our emotions or intellect to interfere with our dialogue.

THE WISE MIND EXERCISE

The Rational Mind

Can you think of a recent occasion when you were coldly rational? Perhaps you were making a plan in a way that made absolute sense, but maybe didn't take account of the feelings of others? Perhaps you responded to a friend or family member who was emotional with a rational piece of advice and they did not respond rationally? Can you analyse this scenario and see what was happening with you and the person you were interacting with?

Situation:

Action/Behaviour:

Outcome:

Analysis:

The Emotional Mind

Can you think of times recently in which you were acting from a place of emotion? Perhaps you got angry or very happy? Can you think of decisions that you made whilst in that heightened state of emotion? Describe the outcome and your analysis.





DEVELOPING A **HEALTHY MINDSET**

Situation:

Emotion:

Action/Decision:

Outcome:

Analysis:

The Wise Mind

Now can you think of a recent occasion where you managed to balance your rational and emotional brain during an interaction?

See if you can remember one and write down the details:

Situation:



DEVELOPING A **HEALTHY MINDSET**

Emotion/Thoughts:

Action/Decision:

Outcome:

Analysis:

Using the Wise Mind is like riding a bike: it takes effort, balance, and steering. We can learn to use the Wise Mind just as we learned to ride a bike: through experience. Just as we must pedal to start a bike rolling, we must be willing to make a little extra effort to initiate the wise mind. By analysing our interactions, we make ourselves more mindful of our own balance and whether we are achieving it. Once we have become competent at taming our own emotional triggers, we consequently become efficient in helping other people to tame theirs.

Intuition steers us toward the wise mind. The onslaught of uncomfortable emotions (anxiety, depression, anger, shame, guilt, etc.) is like speeding out of control and losing our balance. We can learn to activate the wise mind to regain and maintain balance.

As we develop our wise mind, we naturally and gradually develop a sense of inner confidence to move through the challenging moments. We can still make mistakes or lose our balance, but we will maintain our sense of perspective and be quicker at recovering balance.

When we access the wise mind we are able to:

- Maintain or regain calmness when attacked or confronted
- Intuitively sense what will calm emotions in the heat of internal crisis or conflict
- Find clarity of choice when confused
- Be sensitive to the state of others in our decision making



DEVELOPING A **HEALTHY MINDSET**

QUESTIONS FOR SELF-REFLECTION:

- 1)** What steps can you take today to further develop the growth of the wise part of your mind?
- 2)** How might you encourage your future clients to further develop the wise part of their mind?
- 3)** How might your clients benefit from developing the wise part of their mind?

